



Management
System
ISO 9001:2015
www.tuv.com
C. 0138822006



Republic of the Philippines
CAMARINES NORTE STATE COLLEGE
F. Pimentel Avenue, Brgy. 2, Daet, Camarines Norte – 4600, Philippines

College of Arts and Sciences
Summ

CINEMA

Cinema Topics: The Meaning and Nature of Cinema, Types of Film Making, Elements of Cinema, Cinematographic Techniques, Four Aesthetic Factors, Problems of the Philippine Movie Industry, Television, Cinematography.

Submitted by:

Asilum, Paul Daniel

Besenio, Janel

Bola, Lheo Angelo

Gerona, Clifford

Minguez, Louize Zxedric

Nocillado, Niecel Jane

Ong, Mark Gabrielle

Sarion, Jonaz Euan

Secillano, Rhain Jefferzon

Tugano, Dhan Rey

Vasquez, Juliusz Elmarson

Villfranca, Lovely

Course: GE ELECTIVE 6 | Reading in Visual Arts

Instructor: Ma'am Jhonna D. Alcantara, LPT

Submitted on: March 25, 2026

I. Introduction

"Why do films move us even when we know they are fictional?" This question highlights the powerful influence of cinema as both an art form and a medium of communication. Cinema and television have become central to modern life, shaping culture, influencing opinions, and reflecting societal values.

Cinema combines storytelling, visuals, and sound to create meaningful experiences, while television brings similar content directly into people's homes. This paper explores the nature of cinema, its elements and techniques, and examines the current challenges faced by the Philippine movie industry.

II. Background/Context

The Meaning and Nature of Cinema

- **Cinema** is the art of motion pictures that combines storytelling with visual and auditory elements. It is both an *artistic expression* and a *technological innovation*.
- **Cinema** reflects human experiences, cultural values, and social realities. It can entertain, educate, persuade, and inspire audiences.
- The **nature of cinema** lies in its ability to create illusions of movement and reality through a sequence of images. It engages viewers emotionally and intellectually, making it a unique form of art that blends creativity with technical expertise.

Key Terms and Concepts

- **Cinema:** Derived from the Greek kinema (movement), it refers to the art of simulated experiences that communicate ideas, stories, and beauty through motion pictures.



Management
System
ISO 9001:2015
CERTIFIED
www.tuv.com
C. 913862206



Republic of the Philippines
CAMARINES NORTE STATE COLLEGE
F. Pimentel Avenue, Brgy. 2, Daet, Camarines Norte – 4600, Philippines

College of Arts and Sciences
Summ

- **Cinematography:** The art and technology of motion-picture photography. It involves how the camera captures the "mise-en-scène" (everything placed in front of the camera).
- **Mise-en-scène:** A French term meaning "placing on stage," referring to the arrangement of everything that appears in the framing—actors, lighting, décor, props, and costume.

Types of Filmmaking

- **Narrative Films** – Story-driven films with characters and plots
- **Documentary Films** – Focus on real-life events and issues
- **Experimental Films** – Emphasize artistic expression
- **Animation** – Uses drawn or digital visuals

Elements of Cinema

Cinema consists of three key elements: **time**, **space**, and **sound**.

1. **Time** - Time is the most important element of the cinema. Time in cinema is composed of three aspects: *physical*, *psychological*, and *dramatic* time.

- **Physical time** is the time taken by an action as it is being filmed and as it is being projected on the screen. Films may show things as they are happening in real life, but they do not capture these events in actual motion.
 - *Slow motion* is achieved when the camera takes pictures *faster* than the projector can show them on the screen.



Management
System
ISO 9001:2015
www.tuv.com
C. 013882206



Republic of the Philippines
CAMARINES NORTE STATE COLLEGE

F. Pimentel Avenue, Brgy. 2, Daet, Camarines Norte – 4600, Philippines

College of Arts and Sciences
Summ

- *Accelerated motion* is achieved when the camera takes pictures *slower* than the projector can show them on the screen.
- *Reversed motion* conveys an undoing of time. It is achieved by showing the images taken by the camera in *reverse order*.
- *Stopped motion* is not often used, but is achieved by using still photographs rather than a series of multiple photographs.
- *Flashback* refers to the arrangement wherein the chronological flow of events is interrupted by images of past events.
- *Fast-forward* refers to the arrangement wherein the chronological flow of events is interrupted by images of future events.
- **Psychological time** refers to the emotional impression of the duration of the action experienced by the viewer of a film. Rapid action or lively music makes time go quickly, while a slow pace can induce grief or melancholy and slow down time.
 - *Suspense* consists of delaying the resolution of a situation as to pique the interest of the viewer. Suspense is achieved by withholding information from the audience or one of the characters. Suspense causes the passage of time to appear slower due to the natural impatience or eagerness of the viewer to get the resolution.
- **Dramatic time** refers to the time taken up by the events depicted by the film. A story that tackles a long period of time may utilize flashbacks, include a prologue or an epilogue, or exclude the inessential. A film that depicts a brief period of time may be extended through repetition of different aspects.



Management
System
ISO 9001:2015
www.tuv.com
C. 0138822006



Republic of the Philippines
CAMARINES NORTE STATE COLLEGE

F. Pimentel Avenue, Brgy. 2, Daet, Camarines Norte – 4600, Philippines

College of Arts and Sciences
Summ

2. **Space** - Space is the element of cinema that refers to how the scene is perceived and experienced by the viewer. The experience of space in reality is very different from the experience of space in the cinema. The three-dimensionality and realness of an object in a setting is achieved through the use of three factors: *scale*, *lighting*, and *shooting angle*.

- **Scale** refers to the size of objects on the screen in relation to their surrounding area.

One way to achieve the illusion of scale is by making objects on the set smaller and larger than their real life counterparts. Another way the screen and camera can deceive the viewer about the size of objects is through the location of the camera in relation to the subject.

- *Long shots* are taken when the camera is positioned very far from the subject. Its purpose is to show the extent of the location and the relationship between the subject and the setting.
- *Medium shots* are taken from average distance and are the view of medium extent on a medium scale.
- *Close-up* refers to the camera being so close to the subject that the smallest features of the object that the smallest features of the object can be resolved.

- **Lighting** is used to give the illusion of depth. By positioning the lights in certain ways, the filmmaker can create areas of light and dark, and increase or decrease depth.

- **Shooting angles** refer to the filmmaker shooting scenes from different angles to show their concept of the character or object in the film.

- The camera may be directed *vertically upwards*, making subjects seem larger via severe foreshortening or more powerful.
- The camera may be directed *vertically downwards*. It produces an opposite effect to the previous angle, wherein subjects appear smaller and more inferior.

- The camera may also be oriented *horizontally*. It creates an impression of closeness or equality between the characters in the scene, allowing the viewer to feel as though they are part of or on the same level as the characters.

3. **Sound** - Sound refers to the audio that accompanies a film. While real life is full of sounds, a film needs not record every sound to project its reality onto the screen. The film artist may choose to include only those sounds that they deem useful and relevant to the unraveling of their thoughts and ideas.

- It was not until 1927 in the film *The Jazz Singer*, that film was accompanied with sounds (Aguirre, 2022). Before this, films were made entirely without sounds, and were in the most literal sense moving pictures, with the exception of the subtitles used to convey the story to the audience. These films were referred to as **silent films**, and were typically accompanied by orchestral music to explain, heighten, and fortify the action and emotions flashed on the screen—emphasizing the need for sound in cinema even before the technology for it existed.
- The **dialogue** in a film is different from the dialogue in theater. Stage dialogue is continuous since it is dialogue, while films possess significantly more devices to aid in the telling of the story, allowing dialogue to be minimized. Most notably, films may make use of a **theme melody**—an instrumentation of various sounds separate from the dialogue that serves to convey the message or mood of the story.
- **Silence** is also a form of utilizing sound to convey the meaning of a film. Long moments may pass in a film in silence because it is precisely the lack of sound that conveys the meaning of the scene more forcefully than any sound might fail to do. Silence is used most prevalently in thrillers and genres that make use of *suspense* as a narrative device.

These three elements effectively differentiate cinema from theater.

- **Time** in cinema allows films to repeat, extend, abbreviate, or reverse the scenarios on the screen without danger of being labeled unreal.
- **Space** in cinema allows films to possess different structures from theater space: it lacks the depth, expanse, and existence of real space but is capable of making use of elements that real space cannot, such as dividing and expanding spaces, and shortening and lengthening distances.
- **Sound** in cinema is produced differently from sound in the theater, as stage dialogue is relatively continuous while film sound is capable of using theme melodies and silence to convey its narrative.

Cinematographic Techniques

- *Camera Angles* - (high, low, eye-level)
- *Camera Movements* - (pan, tilt, zoom)
- *Lighting* - (natural, artificial)
- *Shot Types* - (close-up, medium, long shot)
- *Composition* - (framing and balance)

Four Aesthetic Factors

- **Mise-en-Scène**
 - Arrangement of visual elements within a frame.
- **Sound Design**
 - Use of audio to enhance storytelling and emotional impact.
- **Editing (Montage)**
 - Combining shots to create meaning, rhythm, and continuity.

- **Cinematography**

- Visual style and camera work that shape the film's look and mood.

Television

- Television is a medium that delivers audiovisual content to a wide audience through broadcast or digital platforms. Unlike cinema, which is traditionally viewed in theaters, television allows for continuous and accessible viewing at home.
- It plays a significant role in shaping public opinion, culture, and daily entertainment habits (Williams, 2003).

Problems of the Philippine Movie Industry

The Philippine movie industry faces several challenges:

- **High Ticket Prices** – Cinema tickets range from ₱400 to ₱600+, limiting accessibility
- **Piracy** – Causes significant revenue loss
- **High Amusement Tax** – Around 30% tax reduces profits
- **Lack of Government Support** – Limited incentives for filmmakers
- **Strong Foreign Competition** – Hollywood and international films dominate cinemas
- **Formula-Based Films** – Overuse of predictable genres

According to industry reports, these issues hinder growth and discourage innovation (Tiongson, 2013).

III. Argument / Analysis

Our Position: We believe the Philippine movie industry is struggling as it keeps on making the same types of "safe" movies just to make money, stopping our artists from truly being creative.

Supporting Evidence: The Philippines has a great history of movies. However, many films today just follow the same "formula," like romantic comedies or stories about being poor. While these movies make money, they often ignore the artistic side of filmmaking. On the other hand, "Indie" (independent) Filipino films have shown that even with a small budget, we can make great movies that win awards abroad because they focus on better cinematography and better stories.

Counterargument: Some people say we have to make these "formula" movies so that the studios don't go bankrupt. They say we need to compete with big Hollywood movies. Our response is that we can make movies that are both popular and high-quality if we focus more on better camera work and more original stories.

Response: It is possible to create films that are both commercially successful and artistically meaningful by investing in originality and quality production.

IV. Ethical Analysis

Is it right to only care about money?

One view (*Utilitarianism*): This says we should make movies that make the most people happy, which are usually simple comedies.

Another view (*Virtue Ethics*): This says filmmakers have a duty to show the truth and create art that helps our country's culture.

We believe it is an ethical problem when movies only use "poverty" to win awards without actually trying to help the people they are filming. Movies should be made with respect for the people and the culture they represent.

V. Conclusion

Cinema is a powerful medium that blends art, technology, and storytelling to reflect human experiences. Its elements and techniques shape how audiences perceive stories and emotions. However, the Philippine movie industry faces serious challenges, including economic barriers, lack of support, and overreliance on formula-based films. To move forward, filmmakers must balance creativity and profitability, producing films that are both meaningful and engaging. The future of Philippine cinema depends on innovation, support, and a commitment to authentic storytelling.

VI. Assessment

Instructions: Read each question carefully. Write only the **letter** of your chosen answer. Write your answers on a **1 / 4 sheet of paper**.

1. What is cinema primarily considered as?

- | | |
|-----------------|---------------------|
| A. Literature | B. Visual art |
| C. Theater only | D. Photography only |



Management
System
ISO 9001:2015
www.tuv.com
C. 0138822006



Republic of the Philippines
CAMARINES NORTE STATE COLLEGE
F. Pimentel Avenue, Brgy. 2, Daet, Camarines Norte – 4600, Philippines

College of Arts and Sciences
Summ

2. What does cinema mainly involve?
 - A. Still images
 - B. Moving images with sound
 - C. Written stories
 - D. Paintings

3. Cinema is best described as a combination of which?
 - A. Music and dance only
 - B. Art and technology
 - C. Writing and reading
 - D. Science only

4. Which type of film presents real-life events?
 - A. Narrative
 - B. Documentary
 - C. Fiction
 - D. Fantasy

5. Which type focuses on storytelling?
 - A. Documentary
 - B. Experimental
 - C. Narrative
 - D. Silent

6. Which is an element of cinema?
 - A. Taste
 - B. Sound
 - C. Smell
 - D. Touch

7. What element controls how scenes are visually arranged?
 - A. Editing
 - B. Sound
 - C. Mise-en-scène
 - D. Script

8. What is cinematography?
 - A. Writing Scripts
 - B. Capturing moving images
 - C. Acting in films
 - D. Editing audio



Management
System
ISO 9001:2015
www.tuv.com
C. 9138822006



Republic of the Philippines
CAMARINES NORTE STATE COLLEGE
F. Pimentel Avenue, Brgy. 2, Daet, Camarines Norte – 4600, Philippines

College of Arts and Sciences
Summ

9. Which shot focuses on a subject's emotions?

- A. Long shot B. Medium shot
- C. Close up D. Wide shot

10. Which angle looks down on the subject?

- A. Low angle B. Eye-level
- C. High angle D. Tilt shot

11. What does a long shot show?

- A. Only the face B. Entire body and surroundings
- C. Only background D. Only objects

12. What is the purpose of editing?

- A. To act scenes B. To arrange and refine clips
- C. To record sound D. To design costumes

13. What is included in sound design?

- A. Dialogue only B. Music only
- C. Dialogue, music, and effects D. Silence only

14. Which factor focuses on visual appeal?

- A. Sound B. Theme
- C. Visual Composition D. Dialogue



Management
System
ISO 9001:2015
CERTIFIED
www.tuv.com
C. 0138822006



Republic of the Philippines
CAMARINES NORTE STATE COLLEGE

F. Pimentel Avenue, Brgy. 2, Daet, Camarines Norte – 4600, Philippines

College of Arts and Sciences
Summ

15. Aesthetic factors help improve what?

- A. Budget
- B. Artistic quality
- C. Script length
- D. Actor salary

16. Which is a common issue in the film industry?

- A. Too many awards
- B. Piracy
- C. Too many viewers
- D. Excess funding

17. Limited budget affects what aspect most?

- A. Film quality
- B. Audience behavior
- C. Theater size
- D. Actor height

18. How is television different from cinema?

- A. No visuals
- B. Smaller screen format
- C. No sound
- D. No audience

19. Who is mainly responsible for the film's visual style?

- A. Actor
- B. Director / Cinematographer
- C. Writer
- D. Editor

20. Cinematographic techniques help achieve what?

- A. Better acting
- B. Visual storytelling
- C. Scriptwriting
- D. Marketing



Management
System
ISO 9001:2015
www.tuv.com
C. 0138822006



Republic of the Philippines
CAMARINES NORTE STATE COLLEGE
F. Pimentel Avenue, Brgy. 2, Daet, Camarines Norte – 4600, Philippines

College of Arts and Sciences
Summ

VII. References

Aguirre, A., & Vicencio, A. (2022). *Reading Visual Art, Engaging Visual Culture*. Vibal Group.

Bordwell, D., & Thompson, K. (2019). *Film Art: An Introduction* (12th ed.). McGraw-Hill Education.

Monaco, J. (2009). *How to Read a Film: Movies, Media, Multimedia* (4th ed.). Oxford University Press.

Tiongson, N. G. (2013). *The Urian Anthology 1970–1979*. University of the Philippines Press.

Williams, R. (2003). *Television: Technology and Cultural Form*. Routledge.

Bordwell, D., Thompson, K., & Smith, J. (2019). *Film art: An introduction* (12th ed.). McGraw-Hill Education.